

THRYV PRODUCT CONTENT GUIDE

I. Voice and tone

The Thryv voice is **helpful**, **personalized**, **action-oriented**, and **user-centric**. We respect our customers' time and intelligence. We explain things clearly without talking down to them. We celebrate progress, give straightforward guidance, and focus on outcomes—not jargon.

Characteristic	Description
Helpful	We guide users through our product so they can grow and manage their business. We simplify and streamline their work so they can focus on what they love.
Personalized	We tailor messaging and content to users' specific needs, helping them feel understood and confident in our product. This builds trust.
Action-oriented	We motivate users through the tough parts of growing a business. We guide them toward action and maintain a positive attitude in the face of challenges.
User-centric	We focus on what users can achieve, not what our product does. We prioritize their needs, use language they understand, and keep them at the center of every decision.

Point of view & examples

The Thryv brand speaks in the first and second person, as is common in casual, informal speech. Mixing pronouns is done to create a conversational style that is both motivational and persuasive.

POV	Example
First person	“ <u>Let's</u> get growing.”
Second person	“It's time for <u>you</u> to start growing.”
Combined	“ <u>Let's</u> maximize <u>your</u> digital marketing score to help <u>your</u> business grow.”

II. Components

Headlines

Headlines should deliver a single message. That message may be a benefit statement, feature description, or even a call to action. We avoid putting two messages into a single headline. Secondary messages can be put into subheaders, and additional details can be placed in body copy.

Message and headline

Message	Headline Example
This is the area that contains the key details and information about your business	“Business profile”

Rules

Element	Rule
Capitalization	Sentence case, always.
Periods	Do use periods IF a complete sentence.
Commas	Do use commas if grammatically correct.
Length	Keep headlines short.
Messaging	Communicate a single sentiment.

Subheaders

Subheaders support headlines with additional context or detail, create a hierarchy of information, and break up longer content to make things more readable for the user. The goal is to guide the user without overwhelming them. Subheaders should be short and scannable, generally 1 to 2 sentences that add secondary messages, required details, or a call to action – all supporting the headline.

Message and subheader

Message	Subheader example
In this section, the user can manage and change their business profile information	“Update your business details”

Rules

Element	Rule
Capitalization	Use sentence case, always.
Periods	Do use periods for complete sentences.
Commas	Do use commas and correct grammar.
Length	Limit subheaders to 1-2 sentences.
Messaging	Support headlines with more detail and/or promote an action.

Body copy

Body copy provides more detailed information, explanation or instruction to help the user understand and complete a task, or learn more about a topic. It appears below the headline and subheader, and is written in complete sentences.

Message and body copy

Message	Body copy example
Ask user to enter business information in below form. Tell them where this information will show up, and note that it is required in order to comply with spam regulations.	“Please enter your business details. This information will display in your email footer in compliance with international spam laws.”

Rules

Element	Rule
Capitalization	Use sentence case, always.
Periods	Do use periods and complete sentences.
Commas	Do use commas and correct grammar.
Length	Keep body copy as concise as possible, generally around 3 sentences max.

Messaging	Support headlines and subheaders with further details or instruction.
------------------	---

Modals

Modals allow customers to complete an action without leaving a state/page.

Guidelines

Guideline	Explanation
Keep it focused	A modal should do one thing. If you're asking the user to make a decision, don't also try to educate them or upsell them. One job per modal.
Lead with the action	The headline should tell users what they're doing or deciding, not describe the modal itself. "Delete this contact?" is better than "Confirmation."
Make buttons clear and specific	Avoid generic labels like "Yes" and "No." Use verbs that describe the action: "Delete," "Cancel subscription," "Save changes."
Don't bury the point	Users scan modals quickly. Put the most important information—what's happening and what they need to do—in the first line or two.
Offer a clear exit	Every modal should have an obvious way to close it or go back without taking action.

Rules

Element	Rule
Capitalization	Use sentence case, always.
Periods	Do use periods and complete sentences.
Commas	Use correct grammar, but avoid content requiring excessive use of commas or other punctuation.
Length	Keep as brief and concise as possible. Long blocks of text should not be necessary in a modal.
Buttons	Clear, specific verbs that concisely describe the action.

Alerts

Inline alerts

Inline alerts provide contextual information or feedback directly within a page or form, usually near the relevant content. They help users understand issues, requirements, or status without interrupting their workflow.

Element	Rule
Capitalization	Use sentence case, always.
Periods	Do use periods and complete sentences.
Commas	Do use commas and correct grammar.
Length	Limit alerts to 90 characters or less.

1. Informational

Informational alerts provide a brief description of the issue and guidance on what to do or expect. They may also include a call to action or link.

Guidelines	Example
Describe the issue and tell the user what to expect, or what they need to do.	Your upgrade is processing! You'll be notified when it's ready, usually within 5-15 minutes.

2. Success/confirmation

A success or confirmation message tells the user that an action they took was completed successfully. It provides reassurance and, when needed, tells them what happens next.

Guidelines	Examples
Confirm success with positive or affirming tone.	"Your plan has been upgraded! Premium features and benefits are now available."

3. Warnings/errors

Warnings and errors notify users when something has gone wrong or needs attention before they can proceed. They explain the issue and, when possible, how to resolve it.

Guidelines	Examples
------------	----------

State problem briefly and suggest action to resolve.	Your plan cannot be edited or canceled online. Please contact our support team to make changes.
---	---

Buttons

Button labels tell users what will happen when they click. They should be clear, specific, and action-oriented, typically starting with a verb.

Rules

Element	Rule
Capitalization	Use sentence case, always
Periods	Do not use
Commas	Do not use
Length	Limit to 25 characters max.
Voice	Use active voice

CTAs

Let's be consistent in our use of specific call to action terms. While there may be an occasional exception, consistent CTAs create a cohesive customer experience. Here is a list of common CTAs within the product.

Active/continuous	Dismiss/defer	Neutral/confirmatory	Destructive
Get started	Close	Run report	Delete
Get a demo	Dismiss	Send	Remove
Upgrade now	Not interested	Accept	Cancel
Start now	No thanks	Confirm	
Update	Cancel	Confirm and pay	
Learn more	Maybe later	Pay now	
Submit		Got it	
Continue			
Contact			

View			
Play			

Labels

Labels identify form fields, inputs, or other UI elements, telling users what information is required or what an element does. They should be clear, concise, and positioned close to the element they describe.

Rules

Element	Rule
Capitalization	Use sentence case, always.
Periods	Use for abbreviations, when needed.
Commas	Do not use
Length	25-35 characters

Tooltips

Tooltips provide brief, helpful information when users hover over or tap an element. They clarify functionality or offer context without cluttering the interface.

Guidelines

Guideline	Explanation
Strictly informative	Keep the information concise and to the point.
Avoid links	Do not put unnecessary hyperlinks into tooltips.
Remember, customers have context	Customers are viewing a page or data point; tooltips clarify an element within a larger context.

Rules

Element	Rule
Capitalization	Use sentence case, always.
Periods	Do use periods and complete sentences.
Commas	Do use commas and correct grammar.
Length	120 characters or less.

Pendo tips

Pendo messages are in-app guides that communicate product updates, tips, or prompts to users. They can highlight new features, encourage adoption, or provide contextual help without requiring users to leave the product.

Guidelines

Guideline	Explanation
Keep it short	Users are mid-task. Get to the point in one or two sentences: what's new or what they should do.
Focus on value, not features	Tell users what they'll gain, not just what changed. "Save time with one-click scheduling" beats "We added a new scheduling button."
Include a clear next step	Give users an action to take: try the feature, learn more, or dismiss. Don't leave them wondering what to do with the information.

Rules

Element	Rule
Capitalization	Use sentence case, always.
Periods	Do use periods and complete sentences.
Commas	Do use commas and correct grammar.
Length	Depends on the format. Pendo imposes its own character limits, but the shorter the better.

III. Grammar and style

We mostly follow the [Associated Press \(AP\) Stylebook](#) for grammar and syntax. However, we like to minimize the use of compound sentences and intrusive punctuation. Below are specific grammar and style rules to follow when writing content.

POV

We use the second person to address users. That means we address them as "you." For example, "You can access your reports here." It's important to note that when we speak directly to the user, we don't use the word "user". Instead, use "customer." For example, we'd let them know that "You're a valued customer."

DO	DON'T
When addressing to Thryv users: <i>2nd person: You</i>	<i>1st person: I/we/us</i> <i>3rd person: He/she/it/they/them</i>
When referring to users' clients: <i>3rd person: They/them (gender neutral)</i>	<i>1st person: I/us</i> <i>2nd person: You</i> <i>3rd person: He/she/it</i>
When referring to ourselves (Thryv): <i>1st person: We/let's/our</i>	<i>1st person: I/us</i> <i>2nd person: You</i> <i>3rd person: He/she/it/they/them</i>

Use active voice

When you use active voice, the subject is doing something to the object. With passive voice, something is being done to the object. Don't use passive voice in the product.

DO	DON'T
Active: You will sell your products.	Passive: Your products will be sold.

Capitalization

Capitalization

Use sentence case in all instances, unless the word is a proper noun or the name of a Thryv feature or tool.

Features and tools

- **Always** capitalize when used as a proper noun:

Set up Appointments

- **Never** capitalize when used as a common noun:

Do you want to schedule an appointment with Jill?

If you're unsure about the capitalization for a specific feature or term, consult the Thryv Dictionary.

Punctuation

Periods

Use periods to end full sentences. Any sentence followed by a link should also have a period (links on their own do not require periods). Below is a chart of when and when not to use periods:

Body copy	Do
Bulleted lists	Don't for fragments Do for sentences
Buttons	Don't
Empty states	Do for sentences
Error messages and alerts	Do for sentences
Headlines	Don't
Labels	Don't
Subheaders	Don't
Toast messages (e.g., Pendo)	Do for sentences

Tooltips	Do for sentences
----------	-------------------------

Commas

- **Do** use commas in body copy, and if needed, sparingly in headlines.
- **Don't** use commas in forms, buttons, or labels.
- **Avoid** using the serial or Oxford comma.
- **Avoid** semicolons.

Colons

- **Do** use colons to introduce lists or explanations:

Choose a plan:

- **Don't** use colons in button labels or menu items.

Exclamation points

- **Don't** use in error messages.
- **Do** use sparingly when appropriate, such as in celebration messages. Never use more than one exclamation point.

Success! Your file was uploaded.

Quotation marks

- **Do** use for direct quotes or referencing interface elements. Use double (") rather than single (') quotes.
- **Avoid** overuse to prevent clutter.

Ampersands (&)

- **Don't** use in any product content. Always spell out "and."

Bulleted lists

- **Do** use for two list items or more, or to break up blocks of content.
- **Don't** use for a single list item.

Ellipses (...)

- **Don't** use anywhere.

Dates and times

Date formatting

- Use only numerical figures for dates and years:

June 1, not June 1st

- **Don't** use a comma between the month and year when they stand alone:

December 2025

- **Do** use a comma when a specific date is included:

December 24, 2025

- **Don't** use the format 12/8/25
- **Don't** use leading zeros (December 08, 2025)
- Format years as YYYY:

1998, not 98

Abbreviations

- Spell out months when used alone or with a year only.
- Abbreviate months when space is limited, such as in tables, dashboards, charts, dropdowns, etc.
- **Don't** abbreviate months when writing longer form content in body copy, or when the month appears alone without a day (e.g., August 2025).
- Use standard 3-letter abbreviations for months.

Time formatting

- Use a 12-hour time format and always include AM or PM:

3:45 PM

- Use time zone labels if it's not the user's local time:

2:30 AM PST

Relative dates and time

- When using, format as such for events within the past 24 hours:

5 minutes ago

- Switch to absolute date after 24 hours:

Yesterday at 1:30 PM

Currency

Symbols

- Use a symbol when the context is clear:

\$99.00

- No spaces between the symbol and amount.
- Use currency code when supporting multiple currencies in a single view, or when the symbol may apply to more than one currency (\$ could be USD or CAD):

USD 99.00, CAD 99.00

Decimals

- Use a comma for thousands and a period for decimals:

\$1,450.21

- Always use two decimal places for currencies with cents, unless whole units are intended.

Zero values

- Format as \$0.00
- For free offerings, format as \$0.00 in invoices or checkout forms, **not** “Free”

Negative values

- Use the minus sign for negative values:
-\$25.00

Measurements

Use numerals, not words, for measurements:

3 inches (**not** three inches)

Exception: spell out numbers at the start of a sentence.

Put a space between the number and the unit when abbreviated:

3 in (**not** 3in)

Exception: no space for ° in temperature: 75°F

- **Don't** pluralize symbols or abbreviations:

5 in (**not** 5 ins)

- **Do** use an en dash (**not** a hyphen) for ranges:

5–7 in

For file sizes, use binary multiples in uppercase with no periods:

KB, MB, GB

Be consistent when rounding within one context or flow, and don't mix imperial and metric units (in/cm) unless writing a conversion.

Things to avoid

Don't use emojis

- We're helpful and warm, but we're not silly or goofy. 🤖 🤔 🤨 Emojis make us seem like we aren't taking our users seriously or that we're being too casual.

Words to avoid

Some are jargony, some are offensive. If you aren't sure if a word should be used, ask a content designer. Don't use:

- Stress, angst, pain, or similar words describing negative emotional states
- Broke, poor, make ends meet, or words that describe a precarious financial situation
- Young, old, elderly, or any other word describing a person's age
- Crazy, insane, or similar words to describe people's mental states
- Best-in-breed
- Disabled, blacklist, whitelist, grandfathered, slave, master, deaf, blind, and any other racist or ableist terms

Use sparingly

- Outcomes, funnel, incentives, leverage, disruptor, thought leader, learnings, or other corporate or marketing terms

What we call users

Thryv has three terms for our users. They are related, but have different meanings and should be used accordingly:

Partners

A **partner** is a business or individual who promotes, sells, or implements Thryv's products for their customers. Partners may include consultants, agencies or certified experts who help small businesses get the most out of our CRM and business management software.

Customers

A **customer** is a small business owner or team member who uses Thryv products to manage and grow their business. Customers may purchase their app directly or through a partner.

Clients

Clients are the people our customers sell their services to.

Rule	In-app usage example
------	----------------------

• Thryv and Keap have customers. ◦ Thryv and Keap partners also have customers.	Thank you for being a Thryv customer.
• Thryv and Keap's customers have clients.	Send an email to your clients about an upcoming sale.

